

Outlook

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Sent	Wed, 09 Nov 2022 15:32:00 -0000

Follow-up: the active-account number may be flattering us

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

The board keeps using active accounts as a proxy for customer primacy, and that assumption needs to be challenged. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. The first extracts did not reconcile, which means source precedence and exclusions must be part of the answer.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if fee or service friction precedes the drop in activity?
2. What evidence would instead support that regular inflows and recurring payments indicate a primary relationship?
3. How do we rule out that customers keep the account open but move useful activity elsewhere?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use November 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards how Keystone should define a primary customer and which customers need service recovery rather than marketing. A useful output would be a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review.

Use monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Use transaction behaviour as a proxy. Do not claim to observe activity held at another bank.

Regards